

Germany to set position on EU-China trade in October, Merz says

送信者: POLITICO Pro Alert 受信日時: 2026-08-26 23:31

【要点】

- ・ドイツ政府は10月までにEUに対し、中国との貿易政策をより厳しくするための提案を提示する予定であると、メルツ首相が発表した。
- ・EUは6月に北京との貿易対話を開始し、中国との日々10億ユーロの貿易赤字を削減することを目指しており、交渉担当者は10月中旬のEU首脳会議で報告することが予想されている。
- ・ドイツの自動車業界や機械・プラント技術産業など産業界でも、中国に対する姿勢が変化しており、各業界団体が新たな方針の策定に取り組んでいる。
- ・財務大臣クリングバイルは、政府が近い将来、中国に関する新たな立場を閣議で最終決定すると述べた。
- ・ドイツは自由でルールに基づいた貿易を支持し続けるが、他国がルールを破る場合には対抗する姿勢を示すとクリングバイルが強調した。

【メール原文】

NEUHARDENBERG, Germany — The German Government intends to put forward proposals to the EU for a tougher trade policy towards China by October at the latest, Chancellor Friedrich Merz said on Wednesday following a cabinet retreat at Neuhardenberg Castle.

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By Romanus Otte · Aug 26, 2026, 4:30 PM · [View in your browser](#)

NEUHARDENBERG, Germany — The German Government intends to put forward proposals to the EU for a tougher trade policy towards China by October at the latest, Chancellor Friedrich Merz said on Wednesday following a cabinet retreat at Neuhardenberg Castle.

Merz said he had asked ministers in his centrist coalition to gather all the proposals and put them in writing. He knew that the EU was waiting for Germany's response on this matter.

"We will make decisions," said Merz. "There will be a clear German position in October."

Brussels launched a trade dialogue with Beijing in June with a view to reducing the bloc's €1 billion-a-day trade deficit with China. Negotiators are expected to report back to EU leaders when they meet for a summit in Brussels in mid-October.

Merz noted that attitudes towards China were also changing within German industry. At present, the trade associations representing the German automotive industry and the mechanical and plant engineering sector, amongst others, are working on new positions regarding China.

At a press conference, Merz was asked about calls to extend the EU's compensatory tariffs on electric cars from China to include passenger cars with hybrid powertrains. The Christian Democrat chancellor did not address this specifically in his reply.

Finance Minister Lars Klingbeil added that the government would “finalise its new position on China in the Cabinet in the near future.” Klingbeil gave a presentation on the subject of China during the closed-door meeting. It became clear during the discussion that “the debate is evolving, if one looks at the past few weeks,” said the Social Democrat leader.

Germany would continue to champion free and rules-based trade, Klingbeil added. However, it would not be naive when others break the rules.

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